

Director and CEO of JSW Energy.

“We are steadily transitioning towards a low-carbon, renewable-led portfolio, while concurrently investing in energy storage and emerging areas such as green hydrogen,” he adds.

Unlike pure-play renewable developers, the company is pursuing an integrated strategy that combines renewable expansion with dispatchable capacity. It maintains that renewable energy, in isolation, cannot yet meet the country’s round-the-clock reliability requirements.

“Our growth is aligned with India’s transition priorities, with a clear focus on scaling renewables, strengthening grid flexibility and ensuring energy security,” Mahendra says. “While we are accelerating renewable capacity supported by storage and hybrid solutions, our efficient thermal fleet continues to provide essential dispatchable power that underpins grid reliability.”

JSW Energy is building a 29.6 GWh locked-in energy storage pipeline across pumped hydro and battery technologies, alongside an operational 25 MW green hydrogen facility in Karnataka.

This approach reflects a broader shift within India’s power sector, where utilities are increasingly combining renewable energy with storage and thermal balancing capacity to manage intermittency and meet rising peak demand.

The operational expansion is also aligned with a wider push within the JSW Group to integrate environmental, social and governance (ESG) considerations into core business strategy and asset development.

“Sustainability leadership is now defined less by commitments and more by the ability to execute



SHARAD MAHENDRA

Joint Managing Director and CEO, JSW Energy

MOST SUSTAINABLE COMPANY IN MANUFACTURING (POWER GENERATION)

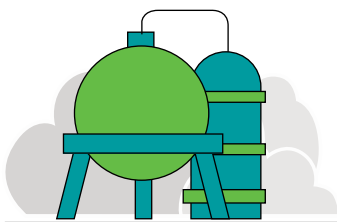
Renewables now make up 59% of JSW Energy’s power generation portfolio

JSW Energy will retain thermal assets alongside renewables to support grid stability and energy security

The company has commissioned and is operating India’s largest 25 MW green hydrogen plant

JSW Energy plans ₹20,000 crore capital expenditure this fiscal year to add 3 GW of green energy capacity

The company is building a 29.6 GWh energy storage pipeline



at scale with credibility,” says Prabodha Acharya, Chief Sustainability Officer at JSW Group. “In hard-to-abate sectors like power and steel, the transition must balance decarbonisation with reliability and energy security.”

He adds that the group is embedding climate-risk considerations into planning and operations. “Our climate-risk assessments aligned with global frameworks evaluate both physical and transition risks and are integrated into project design and operational decision-making. This is particularly critical in water-stressed and climate-sensitive regions.”

Water stewardship is a key focus area. “We are driving high levels of water recycling, reuse and the adoption of efficient cooling technologies, significantly reducing freshwater dependency across

key assets,” Acharya says. The group has also strengthened its approach to biodiversity and land use. “We follow a clear avoid-minimise-restore hierarchy to ensure responsible siting and ecosystem protection around new developments,” he adds.

Over the next three to five years, JSW Energy plans to continue scaling renewable energy and storage capacity, while maintaining a calibrated level of thermal generation to support system reliability and fund growth.

“Delivering firm, round-the-clock green power at scale remains a key priority,” Mahendra says. “This will be enabled through a combination of renewables, storage and efficient thermal capacity, ensuring we support both India’s decarbonisation goals and its growing energy demand.” **BT**

@neetu_csharma